Vanina Pappacena

Dublin, Ireland | Hybrid / Remote | Visa sponsorship required

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Digital Transformation Lead · Facilitation | Organizational Design Strategist | Programme Governance · Service Design · DesignOps | Ex-GovTech: 50+ services, 3M+ citizens | Dublin

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior digital transformation professional with 8+ years of experience establishing governance frameworks, operating models and portfolio reporting in large, regulated public sector environments. Experienced in assessing and selecting technology platforms and vendors through formal evaluation criteria, translating strategic priorities into prioritised initiatives, and tracking benefits through executive dashboards. Combines governance rigour with a human-centred approach to adoption and stakeholder alignment.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Programme & Portfolio Governance | Technology & Vendor Evaluation | Operating Model Design | Executive Reporting & Dashboards | Benefits Realisation | PMO / Programme Office Establishment | Risk, Dependency & Escalation Management | Stakeholder Engagement & Management | Cross-functional Leadership | Change Enablement & Organisational Readiness | Public Sector Transformation

WORK EXPERIENCE

Strategic Design and Innovation Consultant

Independent Consultant | Remote | Dec 2021 – Present

(Parallel to government roles 2021–2023; full-time from 2024)

- Established programme governance structures and operating models for client organisations navigating complex change, defining roles, accountability frameworks, reporting cadences and risk management approaches.
- Led change enablement engagements for Bleett (tech startup): conducted organisational diagnostics, designed the programme of change across design, product and engineering, and managed delivery through structured phases: stabilisation, strategic alignment and AI integration.
- Partnered with Calicó (logistics) on service strategy and operational design, improving work cycles, solution clarity and service accessibility.
- Facilitated process design and team alignment workshops for I+D IoT Lab, clarifying roles, decisions and workflows.
- Delivered stakeholder engagement and organisational readiness programmes for leadership teams navigating growth, structural change and operational complexity.
- Produced integrated reporting and change metrics for senior leadership: milestone tracking, risk and dependency status, and benefits realisation indicators.
- Facilitated executive-level discovery and alignment workshops for founders and C-suite, translating ambiguous transformation priorities into structured roadmaps, governance models and phased delivery plans.
- Acted as a trusted adviser to senior leadership on programme governance, change strategy and organisational design.

Strategic Innovation Consultant

Secretaría de Innovación y Transformación Digital, Government of the City of Buenos Aires | Buenos Aires, Argentina | Jul 2022 – Dec 2023

- Provided strategic consulting to the Secretary of Transformation and Innovation on citizen-centric digital product initiatives.
- Designed user experiences and optimised workflows for key digital government services, improving usability and accessibility for citizens.

- Collaborated with internal government teams to facilitate the adoption and implementation of improved design processes and user-centered methodologies.

UX & Design Systems Manager | Senior Change & Transformation Lead

Government of the City of Buenos Aires | Buenos Aires, Argentina | Nov 2021 – Jul 2022

- Continued building the change governance function across a portfolio of 50+ digital service initiatives, covering operating model, delivery assurance and framework design.
- Continued leading Obelisco, the City's centralised design system, scaling its governance and adoption across 50+ digital touchpoints serving 3M+ citizens.
- Designed portfolio reporting for senior leadership: milestones, risks, dependencies, benefits and organisational impact.
- Created executive dashboards and programme status updates across multiple concurrent workstreams.
- Led governance, risk, dependency and escalation management for a team of 20+ across usability, accessibility, analysis, front-end development and communications.
- Developed organisational readiness and adoption strategies that reduced delivery friction by approximately 40%.
- Tracked benefits realisation: linked change initiatives to measurable outcomes in service quality and team efficiency.

Submanager of Accessibility and Usability

Government of the City of Buenos Aires | Buenos Aires, Argentina | Mar 2020 – Dec 2021

- Defined technical and experience requirements for a public tender and served on the evaluation committee, assessing vendor proposals on technical quality and infrastructure capability to select the platform behind the City's online government services.
- Led a public sector change and improvement programme for accessibility and usability across digital services, managing stakeholder engagement, readiness assessments and compliance delivery in a complex regulatory environment.
- Managed rapid programme mobilisation during the pandemic, delivering three critical services under crisis conditions with no interruption.
- Started the design and governance of Obelisco, the City's centralised design system, and began building the change governance function for the City's digital service initiatives.
- Led a team of 20+ across usability, accessibility, analysis, front-end development and communications.
- Collaborated across government functions to embed new standards into operational delivery, tracking adoption and reporting on progress to senior leadership.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a change governance function and operating model across a 50+ initiative public sector portfolio (2020–2022).
- Reduced delivery friction by ~40% through governance design and adoption planning.
- Led 20+ people across usability, accessibility, analysis, front-end development and communications.
- Delivered three digital services under crisis conditions with no service interruption during the pandemic.
- Defined requirements and served on the evaluation committee for a public tender to select the City's online services platform.
- Advised ministry-level leadership directly on programme governance and transformation priorities.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Interactive Design

University of Buenos Aires (UBA-FADU) | Thesis: Design in Dialogue with Ethics (completed and defended 2024)

Bachelor's Degree in Graphic Design

University of Buenos Aires (UBA-FADU) | 2008 – 2016

Diploma in Web Usability and Accessibility

National Technological University (UTN) | 2017

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

OKRs Design Certified | Agile Quest

Management 3.0 | Agile Spin

LANGUAGES

English: Professional Working Proficiency (B2+) | Spanish: Native